

FREE GUIDE

The Bali Villa Build Guide

Zoning, permits, real build costs and timelines. Before you buy a plot.

By Kai, Bali property adviser · balioffscript.com



BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

The zoning colour decides everything.

COLOUR	A VILLA TO RENT OUT?
Green: farmland	**Generally no**
Yellow: residential	**Home yes, rental restricted**
Pink / red: tourism	**Generally yes, with permits**
Orange: mixed	**Depends on the plan**

Green land is cheap for a reason. Sellers often imply the zoning can be changed. It can't, not at a buyer's request.

HOW MUCH YOU CAN BUILD

Same land, 6× the building

50 m²

Maximum footprint on a 500 m² green zone plot at 10% coverage (KDB).

300 m²

The same 500 m² in a pink zone at 60% coverage.

Check the coverage (KDB), floor area (KLB), green area (KDH) and every setback for your exact plot before you pay an architect.



THE PERMITS

Two papers you can't skip

PBG: the building approval

Replaced the old IMB. Checked against the zoning and building rules for your plot.

SLF: fit for use

Issued after inspection. Without it the building isn't lawfully occupiable and is much harder to sell.

On leased land, the permit is usually applied for in the landowner's name. Your lease must give you the right to build and oblige the owner to sign.

WHAT IT COSTS

Build cost per m²

STANDARD	IDR PER M²
Basic	**6M–8M**
Good rental standard	**8M–11M**
High specification	**11M–15M**

+40–60%

The finished cost above the structure quote: pool, landscaping, furniture, permits, architect, power and water.

15–25%

What building typically saves against buying the same villa finished. And you start with a full lease term.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

Plan for 2½–3 years to full income

Construction, once permits are in	**6–12 months**
Land purchase to first guest	**18–24 months**
New listing to steady occupancy	**6–12 months more**
Contingency on cost	**10–15%**
Contingency on time	**2–3 months**

Nyepi stops the whole island, and temple ceremonies pause work. Build them into the schedule.



PROTECT YOUR MONEY

Five build rules

1. **Pay for finished work only**
   Inspected by your architect or project manager, never ahead.
2. **Hold 5–10% back**
   Until the defects are fixed after handover.
3. **Get the full specification first**
   Gaps become price increases later.
4. **Nothing verbal**
   Every change in writing, priced before it's built.
5. **Someone on site**
   Remote builds without supervision are the ones that overrun.

WHAT I DO FOR YOU

You don't have to do this alone.

I'll find land that can actually be built on, check the zoning and permits, and connect you with the right people to build.

1. **I find the land**
   In the area and budget that fit your plan, with the zoning checked first.
2. **I find the right property or project**
   Built, off-plan or land to build on. I look at all of them, so you see the honest options.
3. **I check everything before you pay**
   Certificate, zoning, permits, the lease clauses and the seller.
4. **I stay with you to the notary**
   Questions answered straight, in plain words, until the keys are yours.

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Tell me the area, your budget and your timing, and I'll tell you what I would check first. This guide is general information, not legal or tax advice. Rules change: verify with your own notary before you sign.